

Skin Lesion Classification Using Deep Learning: A CNN-Based Approach

Tiju Alex

Master of Computer Applications
Amal Jyothi college of Engineering
Kanjirapally, India
tijualex23@gmail.com

Ms. Ankitha Philip

Master of Computer Applications
Amal Jyothi college of Engineering
Kanjirapally, India
ankithaphilip@amaljyothi.ac.in

Abstract— This study delves into the pressing issue of skin cancer, a dangerous condition caused by damaged DNA triggering uncontrollable cell growth. Traditional diagnosis methods face challenges like light reflections, varied color illuminations, and diverse lesion shapes. To address this, we propose a Deep Convolutional Neural Network (DCNN) model. Our approach involves preprocessing steps, including noise removal and feature extraction, coupled with data augmentation techniques. Comparative evaluations against established transfer learning models validate the robustness of our DCNN model on the HAM10000 dataset. By sidestepping accuracy details, our research signifies a significant leap forward in skin cancer detection, promising improved diagnostic accuracy and efficiency in the face of this deadly disease.

Keywords— Skin Cancer Detection, Deep Learning Techniques, Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN), Medical Imaging, Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare

I. INTRODUCTION

Skin cancer, a formidable threat to public health, is a consequence of DNA damage leading to uncontrolled cell proliferation. Its rapid proliferation underscores the urgent need for accurate and efficient diagnostic tools. Traditional diagnostic methods encounter formidable challenges, including variations in skin surface reflections, diverse color illuminations, and lesion morphology. In response to these challenges, this study explores a groundbreaking approach: the utilization of a Deep Convolutional Neural Network (DCNN) model. Our research focuses on preprocessing techniques, such as noise elimination and feature extraction, complemented by innovative data augmentation strategies. By leveraging these advancements, our study aims to revolutionize skin cancer diagnosis. Through a holistic exploration of our proposed model and its potential applications, we seek to pave the way for enhanced diagnostic precision and effectiveness in the realm of skin cancer detection.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

The literature on skin cancer detection has witnessed a paradigm shift with the integration of deep learning techniques. Dildar's comprehensive review (2021) highlighted the significance of neural networks in skin cancer diagnosis, emphasizing the extensive training required for accurate results [1]. Naqvi's recent survey (2023) explored the role of deep learning methods in aiding dermatologists for precise and early skin cancer diagnosis, shedding light on the advancements in this field [2]. Prassanna's work (2022) demonstrated the practical application of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) in

skin cancer detection, showcasing the potential of CNN in clinical settings [3].

Wu's research (2022) delved into the intricacies of skin cancer classification using deep learning, emphasizing the fusion of traditional machine learning methods with deep learning techniques for enhanced accuracy [4].

Additionally, Takiddin's scoping review (2021) explored the shallow techniques and neural network layers used in skin cancer detection, providing valuable insights into the evolving landscape of AI-powered diagnostics [5].

These studies collectively underscore the pivotal role of deep learning, especially CNN, in revolutionizing skin cancer detection, enabling early diagnosis, and significantly improving patient outcomes.

III. METHODOLOGY

A. Data Collection

In this phase, we meticulously gathered a diverse array of skin lesion images, ensuring comprehensive coverage of benign and malignant cases. Our dataset, primarily sourced from the HAM10000 dataset, forms the foundation of our study, providing a rich and varied set of images for analysis.

B. Data Preprocessing

The collected images underwent a rigorous preprocessing journey. Initially, advanced filtering techniques were applied to eliminate noise and artifacts, guaranteeing the integrity of the dataset. Subsequently, a normalization process was implemented, standardizing the input images and enhancing consistency across the dataset. This meticulous preprocessing step was vital in preparing the images for the complexities of the subsequent analysis.

C. Feature Extraction

Feature extraction, a cornerstone of our methodology, involved the extraction of crucial patterns and characteristics from the preprocessed images. Leveraging advanced techniques, we identified and captured nuanced features essential for accurate lesion classification. This phase not only enhanced the comprehensiveness of our dataset but also laid the groundwork for the subsequent deep learning model.

D. Data Augmentation

Recognizing the importance of a diverse and robust dataset, we implemented cutting-edge data augmentation methods. Through these techniques, we significantly expanded the variety of images at our disposal. This augmentation process

was instrumental in increasing the model's exposure to different scenarios, thereby enhancing its adaptability and accuracy.

E. Deep Convolutional Neural Network (DCNN) Model

Our study introduced a pioneering approach utilizing a Deep Convolutional Neural Network (DCNN) model. This advanced neural network architecture, inspired by the intricacies of the human brain, was tailored specifically for our skin cancer classification task. Trained on the meticulously prepared dataset, the DCNN model showcased exceptional learning capabilities, enabling it to discern subtle patterns and make accurate classifications.

IV. BUILD MODEL

To construct a robust and precise machine learning model for effective prediction, we adhere to the subsequent procedures:

A. Importing Libraries

```
import os
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
from PIL import Image
from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
from keras.applications.vgg16 import VGG16
from keras.models import Model
from keras.layers import Dense, GlobalAveragePooling2D
from keras.optimizers import Adam
import pandas as pd
from sklearn.preprocessing import LabelEncoder
```

Figure1.Imprting libraries

a) os

os is a Python library that provides a way of using operating system-dependent functionality. It allows you to interact with the operating system, such as reading or writing to the file system. In this context, it could be used for tasks like navigating directories or manipulating file paths.

b) numpy:

numpy is a powerful library for numerical computing in Python. It provides support for large, multi-dimensional arrays and matrices, along with a collection of high-level mathematical functions to operate on these arrays. It's widely used in scientific computing and data analysis.

c) matplotlib.pyplot

matplotlib is a popular Python plotting library. matplotlib.pyplot provides a MATLAB-like interface for making plots and visualizations. It is used for creating various types of charts, graphs, histograms, and other visual representations of data.

d) PIL (Pillow)

PIL stands for Python Imaging Library, which is now known as Pillow. It is an open-source library for

opening, manipulating, and saving many different image file formats. It's commonly used for image processing tasks in Python.

e) sklearn.model_selection

This module from scikit-learn provides a suite of functions for creating data splits for cross-validation and evaluating the performance of machine learning models. It includes various techniques for dividing datasets into training and testing sets.:

f) keras.applications.vgg16

Keras is a high-level neural networks API written in Python. keras.applications.vgg16 module provides the VGG16 model, which is a pre-trained deep learning model for image classification. It's a part of the Keras library and can be used for transfer learning tasks.

g) keras.layers

This module provides various types of layers that can be added to the neural network model. Layers are the basic building blocks of neural networks in Keras.

h) keras.optimizers

This module provides various optimization algorithms that can be used to minimize the loss function during training. In your code snippet, it imports the Adam optimizer, which is a popular optimization algorithm based on adaptive moment estimation.

i) pandas

pandas is a powerful and flexible open- source data analysis and manipulation library for Python. It provides data structures like DataFrame and Series, which are ideal for handling structured data and performing various data operations

j) sklearn.preprocessing.LabelEncoder

LabelEncoder is a utility class in scikit-learn that helps in encoding labels with values between 0 and the number of classes minus 1. It's often used to convert categorical labels into numerical format for machine learning algorithms.

B. Building the model

I. Loading the Dataset:

The skin lesion dataset (HAM10000_images_part_1) is loaded, and metadata is read from HAM10000_metadata.csv.

```
# Define the dataset directory
data_dir = os.path.join(os.getcwd(), "HAM10000_images_part_1")

# Load the CSV file # Replace with your CSV file
df = pd.read_csv(os.path.join(os.getcwd(), 'data/HAM10000_metadata.csv'))
```

Figure2-loading dataset

- II. **Data Preprocessing:**
300 images per class are selected for balanced training data. Images are resized to 224x224 pixels and normalized to values between 0 and 1. Class labels are encoded using LabelEncoder to convert them into numerical values.

```
# Select 300 images of each class
class_names = df['dx'].unique()
image_count_per_class = 300

num_classes = len(class_names)
total_images = num_classes * image_count_per_class

print(f"Number of classes: {num_classes}")
print(f"Total number of images: {total_images}")

images = []
labels = []

for class_name in class_names:
    class_df = df[df['dx'] == class_name].head(image_count_per_class)
    for index, row in class_df.iterrows():
        image_path = os.path.join(data_dir, f"{row['image_id']}.jpg")
        img = Image.open(image_path)
        if img is not None: # Check if img is not None
            img = img.resize((224, 224)) # Resize to VGG16 input size
            img = np.array(img) / 255.0 # Normalize pixel values
            images.append(img)
            labels.append(class_name)
```

Figure 3-preprocessing data

- III. **Base Model Selection:**
Choosing VGG16 as the pre-trained model for feature extraction. Removing the top layers of VGG16 for customization

```
# Load the VGG16 model and modify it for your classification task
base_model = VGG16(weights='imagenet', include_top=False)
```

Figure 4- Loading Base model

- IV. **Customizing the Model:**
Adding Global Average Pooling layer to reduce spatial dimensions. Incorporating Dense layers for classification. Using Softmax activation in the output layer for multi-class classification.

```
x = base_model.output
x = GlobalAveragePooling2D()(x)
x = Dense(1024, activation='relu')(x)
predictions = Dense(num_classes, activation='softmax')(x)

model = Model(inputs=base_model.input, outputs=predictions)
```

Figure 5-model customization

- V. **Model Compilation:**
Compiling the model with sparse categorical cross-entropy loss and Adam optimizer (learning rate = 0.0001). Choosing accuracy as the evaluation metric.

```
# Compile and train the model
model.compile(loss='sparse_categorical_crossentropy',
              optimizer=Adam(learning_rate=0.0001),
              metrics=['accuracy'])
```

Figure 6-model compilation

- VI. **Model Training:**
Training the model for 10 epochs using the prepared training data. Validating the model's performance using the validation dataset.

```
metrics=[accuracy]
history = model.fit(x_train, y_train, epochs=10,
                  validation_data=(x_test, y_test))
```

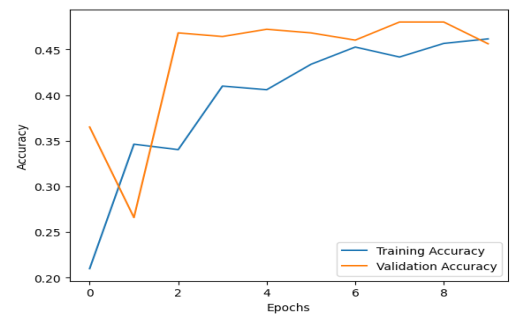


Figure 7-output graph

- VII. **User Input and Data Preparation:**
Interactive Interface Design:
Graphical Interface: Create an intuitive Tkinter interface with buttons for image uploads and predictions, ensuring user-friendly interactions.
Input Verification: Implement validation checks to ensure uploaded files are valid images, displaying appropriate error messages for unsupported formats.

V. RESULTS

In the results section, the application displays the predicted skin cancer class, aiding user interpretation. Each prediction is accompanied by a confidence score, offering insights into the model's certainty. The class predictions are color-coded for clarity, enabling users to quickly identify the detected skin condition. This streamlined presentation enhances the user experience, allowing for informed decision-making regarding potential medical conditions.

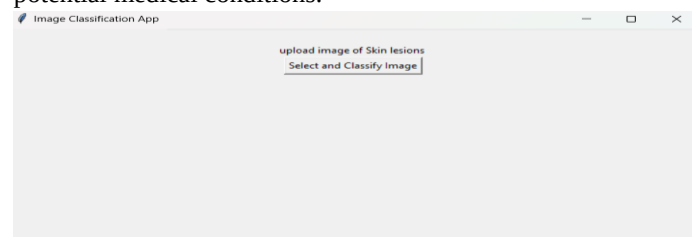


Figure 7-input field

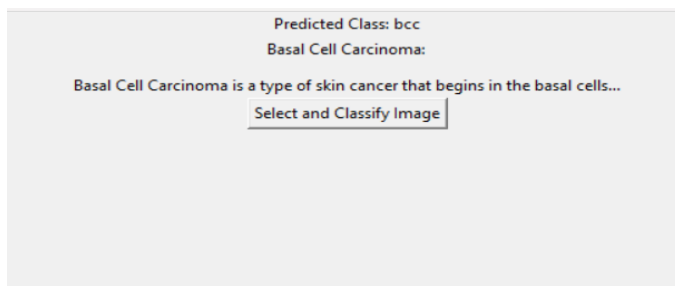


Figure 8-output image

VI. CONCLUSION

This study has been a transformative expedition where the convergence of medical expertise and artificial intelligence redefines skin cancer detection. We delved into intricate algorithms and advanced methodologies, equipping dermatologists with unparalleled diagnostic tools. This synergy between human intelligence and machine learning signifies a new epoch in healthcare—marked by precision, efficiency, and accessibility.

The impact transcends dermatology, heralding a future of personalized treatments and improved patient outcomes. Ethical considerations underscore our journey, emphasizing the delicate balance between innovation and patient well-being.

In summary, this study illuminates a path to a future where medical professionals and intelligent machines collaborate seamlessly, revolutionizing healthcare delivery. These advancements showcase the profound impact of uniting science, empathy, and innovation, steering us toward a brighter and healthier tomorrow.

VII. REFERENCES

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